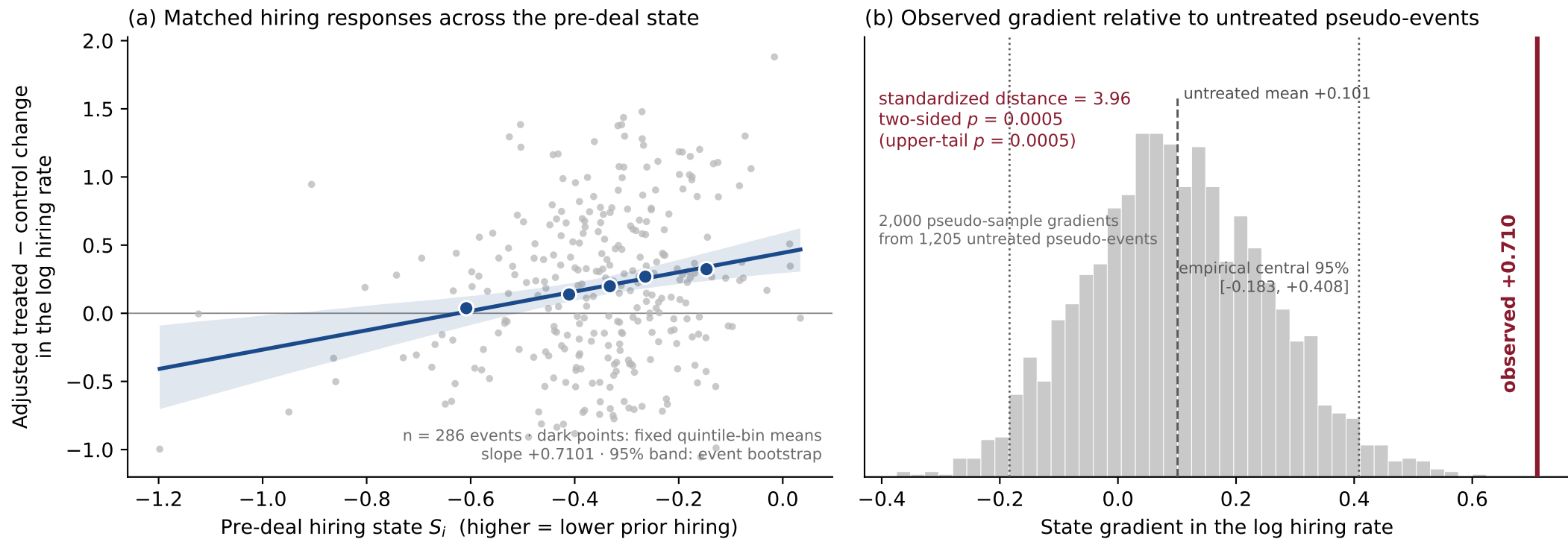


Figure 1. Hiring responses across pre-deal hiring states



Notes. Panel (a) plots the event-level treated-minus-control change in the log hiring rate against the target's pre-deal hiring state in the 286-event primary sample; higher state values indicate lower pre-deal hiring intensity. The display follows the primary specification (5/95 winsorisation; covariates partialled out of both axes, added-variable form); dark points are fixed quintile-bin means of the displayed values. Panel (b) plots the empirical distribution of the 2,000 untreated pseudo-sample gradients described in Section 4.3 — not a fitted normal approximation; vertical markers show the empirical mean and central 95 percent interval.